

Day 53 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Contributions of Thanthai Periyar and Perarignar Anna

READING MATERIAL

Closes Part A Unit VI by focusing specifically on Thanthai Periyar's and Perarignar Anna's distinct, lasting contributions to Tamil Nadu's social and political life — distinguishing this from their personal biographies and party-founding history covered elsewhere.

Q: What were Periyar's main social reform contributions through the Self-Respect Movement (1925)?

A: Promoting social equality, human dignity, and rational thinking; advocating women's education, property rights, widow remarriage, and gender equality; and working toward the eradication of caste discrimination.

Q: What was a 'Self-Respect Marriage', as promoted by Periyar, and what did it reject?

A: A simplified marriage ceremony rooted solely in the mutual consent of the bride and groom — rejecting caste barriers, Brahmin priests, and Sanskrit rituals, in contrast to traditional priest-led ceremonies.

Q: What major language-policy stance did Periyar take in the late 1930s?

A: He led opposition to compulsory Hindi education in the Madras Presidency, viewing it as a threat to Tamil language and cultural identity — an early instance of the anti-Hindi-imposition stance that later became a defining feature of Dravidian politics.

Q: What was C.N. Annadurai's (Perarignar Anna's) unique position in the history of Madras State/Tamil Nadu's Chief Ministership?

A: He was the 4th and LAST Chief Minister of Madras State (1967-1969), and then became the FIRST Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu (after the state was renamed) — serving only about 20 days in that role before his death in office. He was the first member of a Dravidian party to hold either post, and his government was the first in India to be a non-Congress party government with a full majority.

Q: What three concrete policy contributions is Anna's administration specifically credited with?

A: (1) Legalising Self-Respect marriages (giving legal force to Periyar's social reform); (2) Enforcing a TWO-language policy (Tamil and English) for Tamil Nadu, rejecting the three-language formula adopted by other southern states (i.e., no compulsory Hindi); (3) Renaming Madras State to TAMIL NADU (1969).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Periyar's Self-Respect Movement (1925) primarily advocated for:

- A. Restoring traditional caste hierarchies
- B. Social equality, women's rights, and eradication of caste discrimination ✓**
- C. Compulsory Hindi education
- D. Strengthening priest-led religious ceremonies

Explanation: Social equality, women's rights, eradication of caste discrimination. [medium, web-research]

2. A 'Self-Respect Marriage', as promoted by Periyar, is rooted in:

- A. Caste-based matching by elders
- B. The mutual consent of the bride and groom, without priests or Sanskrit rituals ✓**
- C. Astrological compatibility verified by a priest
- D. Government registration only, with a religious ceremony afterward

Explanation: Mutual consent, without priests or Sanskrit rituals. [medium, web-research]

3. In the late 1930s, Periyar led opposition to:

- A. English-medium education
- B. Compulsory Hindi education in the Madras Presidency ✓**
- C. Women's right to vote
- D. The Justice Party's formation

Explanation: Compulsory Hindi education. [medium, web-research]

4. C.N. Annadurai was the LAST Chief Minister of which state, before becoming the FIRST Chief Minister of its renamed successor?

- A. Mysore State
- B. Madras State ✓**

C. Travancore-Cochin

D. Andhra State

Explanation: Madras State, renamed to Tamil Nadu. [medium, web-research]

5. How long did Annadurai serve as the first Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu, before his death in office?

A. About 20 days ✓

B. About 6 months

C. About 2 years

D. A full 5-year term

Explanation: About 20 days. [hard, web-research]

6. Annadurai's government was historically significant as India's first:

A. Coalition government at the Centre

B. Non-Congress party government with a full majority ✓

C. Government to hold a general election

D. Government led by a woman

Explanation: First non-Congress party government with a full majority. [medium, web-research]

7. Which of the following is NOT one of Annadurai's specific policy contributions?

A. Legalising Self-Respect marriages

B. Enforcing a two-language policy (Tamil and English)

C. Renaming Madras State to Tamil Nadu

D. Making Hindi compulsory as a third language ✓

Explanation: He REJECTED compulsory Hindi as a third language — the opposite of this option. [hard, web-research]

8. Madras State was officially renamed Tamil Nadu in:

A. 1956

B. 1965

C. 1969 ✓

D. 1975

Explanation: 1969. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Ratio and Proportion

READING MATERIAL

Ratio & Proportion is 1 of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills, and real exam evidence shows it's tested through several distinct shapes, not just 'simplify this ratio'. Learn each shape as its own method.

Q: Real exam (2025): A man spends Rs.500 buying 12 tables and chairs. One table costs Rs.50, one chair costs Rs.40. Find the ratio of chairs to tables purchased.

A: Let tables= t , chairs= c . $t+c=12$ and $50t+40c=500$ (i.e. $5t+4c=50$). Substitute $t=12-c$: $5(12-c)+4c=50 \rightarrow 60-5c+4c=50 \rightarrow c=10$, so $t=2$. Ratio chairs:tables = $10:2 = 5:1$.

Q: Method — combining two ratios that share a common term: If $a:b=3:5$ and $b:c=7:8$, find $a:c$.

A: To chain two ratios, scale each so the SHARED term (b) matches in both. Here b is 5 in the first ratio and 7 in the second — $\text{LCM}(5,7)=35$. Scale $a:b=3:5$ by $\times 7 \rightarrow a:b=21:35$. Scale $b:c=7:8$ by $\times 5 \rightarrow b:c=35:40$. Now $a:b:c = 21:35:40$, so $a:c = 21:40$.

Q: Method — continued proportion (three terms in one ratio): If $a/10 = b/15 = c/20$, find $a:b:c$.

A: All three fractions equal the same constant, so $a:b:c$ is simply $10:15:20$, which reduces to $2:3:4$ (dividing by the HCF, 5).

Q: Method — chaining two ratios via a shared term: If $A:B=3:4$ and $B:C=8:9$, find $A:C$.

A: B is 4 in the first ratio and 8 in the second — scale the first ratio so B matches: multiply $A:B=3:4$ by 2 to get $A:B=6:8$. Now both ratios share $B=8$: $A:B:C = 6:8:9$. So $A:C = 6:9 = 2:3$.

Q: Method — mixture/alloy adjustment (add a pure ingredient to shift a ratio): A mixture of 60 L has acid:water = $2:1$. How much water must be added to make the ratio $1:2$?

A: Acid:water = $2:1$ in 60L means acid=40L, water=20L. We're only adding water (acid stays at 40L). We want acid:water = $1:2$, i.e. water = $2 \times \text{acid} = 80\text{L}$. Water to add = $80-20 = 60\text{L}$.

Q: Method — simplest form of an age ratio: Azhagan is 50 years old, his son is 10. What is the simplest ratio of their ages?

A: $50:10$ reduces (divide both by 10) to $5:1$.

Q: Method — finding an unknown in a proportion (cross-multiplication): If the numbers 2, 5, x , 20 (in that order) are in proportion, find x .

A: In proportion, $2:5 = x:20$, so $2 \times 20 = 5 \times x \rightarrow 40 = 5x \rightarrow x = 8$. (General rule: in $a:b=c:d$, $a \times d = b \times c$.)

Q: Method — the '4th proportional': Find the 4th proportional to 4, 16, and 7.

A: The 4th proportional x satisfies $4:16 = 7:x \rightarrow 4x = 16 \times 7 = 112 \rightarrow x = 28$.

Q: Method — splitting a total using a 3-part ratio and a given average: Three numbers are in ratio $3:5:7$ and their average is 60. Find the smallest number.

A: Average of 60 over 3 numbers means their total = 180. Split 180 in ratio $3:5:7$ (15 parts total): each part = $180/15 = 12$. Smallest = $3 \times 12 = 36$.

Q: Method — 'duplicate ratio' (squaring a ratio): What is the duplicate ratio of $2:7$?

A: The duplicate ratio of $a:b$ is $a^2:b^2$. So the duplicate ratio of $2:7$ is $4:49$.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. A woman spends Rs.620 buying 14 pens and notebooks. One pen costs Rs.30, one notebook costs Rs.50. Find the ratio of notebooks to pens purchased.

- A. 2:5
- B. 5:2 ✓**
- C. 3:4
- D. 4:3

Explanation: $p+n=14$; $30p+50n=620 \rightarrow 3p+5n=62$. Substitute $p=14-n$: $3(14-n)+5n=62 \rightarrow 42+2n=62 \rightarrow n=10$, $p=4$. Ratio notebooks:pens = $10:4 = 5:2$. [hard, authored]

2. If $x/8 = y/12 = z/20$, find $x:y:z$ in lowest terms.

- A. 2:3:5 ✓**
- B. 8:12:20
- C. 4:6:10
- D. 1:2:3

Explanation: $x:y:z = 8:12:20$, which reduces (divide by HCF=4) to $2:3:5$. [easy, authored]

3. If $P:Q = 2:3$ and $Q:R = 9:10$, find $P:R$.

A. 3:5 ✓

B. 2:5

C. 3:10

D. 9:20

Explanation: Scale $P:Q=2:3$ by 3 to get $P:Q=6:9$, matching $Q=9$ from $Q:R=9:10$. So $P:Q:R=6:9:10$, giving $P:R=6:10=3:5$. [medium, authored]

4. A 40 L mixture has milk:water = 3:1. How much water must be added to change the ratio to 3:2?

A. 5 L

B. 10 L ✓

C. 8 L

D. 6 L

Explanation: Milk:water=3:1 in 40L means milk=30L, water=10L. Milk stays fixed; we want water= $(2/3) \times \text{milk} = (2/3) \times 30 = 20$ L. Water to add = $20 - 10 = 10$ L. [hard, authored]

5. If 5, 8, x, 24 are in proportion, find x.

A. 12.5

B. 15 ✓

C. 16

D. 20

Explanation: $5:8 = x:24 \rightarrow 5 \times 24 = 8x \rightarrow 120 = 8x \rightarrow x = 15$. [easy, authored]

6. Find the 4th proportional to 3, 12, and 9.

A. 27

B. 36 ✓

C. 30

D. 33

Explanation: $3:12 = 9:x \rightarrow 3x = 12 \times 9 = 108 \rightarrow x = 36$. [easy, authored]

7. Three numbers are in the ratio 2:3:4 and their average is 45. Find the largest number.

A. 40

B. 50

C. 60 ✓

D. 45

Explanation: Average 45 over 3 numbers means total=135. 9 parts total, each part=15. Largest = $4 \times 15 = 60$. [medium, authored]

8. What is the duplicate ratio of 3:5?

A. 6:10

B. 9:25 ✓

C. 9:10

D. 3:25

Explanation: Duplicate ratio = square each term: $3^2:5^2 = 9:25$. [easy, authored]

9. A sum of Rs.450 is divided among 100 boys and girls, each boy getting Rs.5.10 and each girl Rs.3.60. Find the number of girls.

A. 20

B. 30

C. 40 ✓

D. 50

Explanation: Let girls=g, boys=100-g. $3.6g + 5.1(100-g) = 450 \rightarrow 3.6g + 510 - 5.1g = 450 \rightarrow -1.5g = -60 \rightarrow g = 40$. [hard, authored]

10. A father's age (40) to his daughter's age (8) — what is the simplest ratio?

A. 5:1 ✓

B. 8:1

C. 4:1

D. 10:1

Explanation: 40:8 reduces ($\div 8$) to 5:1. [easy, authored]

Part C – General English: Prose: "A Prayer to the Teacher" — Subroto Bagchi

READING MATERIAL

A convocation speech by Subroto Bagchi (founder of Mindtree), delivered to graduating teachers at the International Academy for Creative Teaching, Bangalore (6 January 2005), urging them to teach students values like inclusion, genuine communication, and gratitude for nature — going beyond the formal syllabus.

Q: Who delivered "A Prayer to the Teacher", and where was it delivered?

A: Subroto Bagchi, founder and CEO of Mindtree. It was delivered as a convocation address at the International Academy for Creative Teaching, Bangalore, on 6 January 2005, to graduating teachers.

Q: What is the FIRST value the speaker prays teachers will instil in students?

A: Inclusion — valuing all people regardless of boundaries like financial/educational status, caste, creed, physical strength, designation, or place of origin.

Q: What everyday example does the speaker use to illustrate a LACK of inclusion?

A: Not calling a neighbour's child along when taking one's own child to the movies — a small, everyday act that reflects exclusion rather than inclusion.

Q: According to the speaker, what makes learning genuinely joyful?

A: The PROCESS of learning itself — not marks, not memorization, and not merely studying in groups.

Q: What does the speaker ask teachers to teach about communication, and what does he mean by communicating with 'animate and inanimate' things?

A: He asks teachers to teach genuine communication — noting that amid cutthroat competition, the more people try to impress, the less they truly communicate. 'Animate and inanimate' means living and NON-LIVING things alike — he wants students to learn to communicate even with nature and non-living things around them, not just people.

Q: What does the speaker say about nature and gratitude, in an increasingly commercial world?

A: He observes that the things that truly support life come freely from nature — the cow is not paid for the milk it gives, nor does the earth charge money for the crops it produces — urging gratitude for what nature freely provides, rather than treating everything as commercial transactions.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. Who delivered the speech "A Prayer to the Teacher"?

- A. Dr. Abdul Kalam
- B. Subroto Bagchi ✓**
- C. Rabindranath Tagore
- D. Dr. Radhakrishnan

Explanation: Subroto Bagchi. [easy, web-research]

2. Where was the speech delivered?

- A. IIT Delhi
- B. Bangalore University
- C. International Academy for Creative Teaching ✓**
- D. Indian Institute of Science

Explanation: International Academy for Creative Teaching. [medium, web-research]

3. What value does the speaker pray for FIRST in the speech?

- A. Power to rule
- B. A sense of silence
- C. The value of inclusion ✓**
- D. Fame

Explanation: The value of inclusion. [medium, web-research]

4. The speaker compares NOT calling a neighbour's child to the movies with:

- A. Generosity

B. Lack of inclusion ✓

C. Kindness

D. Patriotism

Explanation: Lack of inclusion. [medium, web-research]

5. According to the speaker, what makes learning joyful?

A. Marks

B. Memorization

C. The process of learning ✓

D. Studying in groups

Explanation: The process of learning. [easy, web-research]

6. In "Teach me to communicate with animate and inanimate", what does 'inanimate' mean?

A. Moving

B. Non-living ✓

C. Noisy

D. Intelligent

Explanation: Non-living. [medium, web-research]